50 Essential Polish Phrases for Everyday Situations

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1 Greetings & Small Talk

1. Dzień dobry
Good morning / Good day

Use any time before evening — formal and informal.

2. Cześć
Hi / Bye

Informal — use with friends and family only.

3. Jak się masz?
How are you?

Informal, to someone you know well.

4. Miło mi Cię poznać
Nice to meet you

Say this when meeting someone for the first time.

5. Co słychać?
What's new?

Casual, a common opener among friends.

6. Wszystko w porządku
Everything's fine

Standard, reassuring reply to „Jak się masz?”

7. Do zobaczenia
See you later

Said when parting, expecting to meet again soon.

8. Pozdrowienia dla rodziny
Greetings to your family

Polite phrase to pass on when ending a conversation.

2 At Home

9. Czy mogę otworzyć okno?
Can I open the window?

Polite request — useful when staying with a Polish family.

10. Gdzie jest łazienka?

Where's the bathroom?

One of the most practical questions to know by heart.

11. Zgaś światło, proszę

Turn off the light, please

Everyday household request.

12. Jestem głodny / głodna

I'm hungry (said by a man / a woman)

Polish adjectives change ending with the speaker's gender.

13. Smacznego!

Enjoy your meal!

Always said before eating — never skip it.

14. Pomóc ci posprzątać?

Shall I help you tidy up?

Polite offer, appreciated when you're a guest.

15. Śpię już

I'm going to sleep now

Simple way to say goodnight before bed.

3 Everyday Situations

16. Przepraszam

Excuse me / Sorry

Use to get someone's attention or to apologise.

17. Nie rozumiem

I don't understand

Essential phrase when a conversation moves too fast.

18. Czy mówi Pan/Pani po angielsku?

Do you speak English?

Formal — „Pan” to a man, „Pani” to a woman.

19. Proszę mówić wolniej

Please speak more slowly

Polite way to ask someone to slow down.

20. Która jest godzina?

What time is it?

Standard way to ask the time.

21. Muszę iść

I have to go

Polite way to end a conversation.

22. Nie ma problemu

No problem

Common, friendly reassuring reply.

23. Wszystko jasne

Understood / All clear

Confirms you've followed an explanation.

4 Shopping

24. Ile to kosztuje?

How much does this cost?

The single most useful shopping phrase.

25. Czy mogę zapłacić kartą?

Can I pay by card?

Most shops in Poland accept card payment.

26. Szukam...

I'm looking for...

Follow with the name of the item.

27. Czy jest większy rozmiar?

Is there a bigger size?

Useful in clothes shops.

28. Wezmę to

I'll take this

Simple phrase to confirm a purchase.

29. Czy mogę to przymierzyć?

Can I try this on?

Standard phrase in clothing stores.

30. Proszę paragon

A receipt, please

Always worth asking for.

5 Travel

31. Jak dojść do dworca?

How do I get to the station?

Key question for any traveller.

32. Czy ten autobus jedzie do centrum?

Does this bus go to the centre?

Confirm before boarding.

33. Bilet w jedną stronę, proszę

A one-way ticket, please

Add „powrotny” to ask for a return ticket.

34. Gdzie jest najbliższy bankomat?

Where's the nearest ATM?

Practical for any trip.

35. Czy to daleko stąd?

Is it far from here?

Useful follow-up to any directions given.

36. Zgubiłem / zgubiłam się

I'm lost (said by a man / a woman)

Say this and ask for help finding your way.

37. Czy mogę zrobić zdjęcie?

May I take a photo?

Polite to ask before photographing people or private property.

6 At the Doctor's

38. Źle się czuję

I don't feel well

Opening line for any medical situation.

39. Boli mnie głowa

I have a headache

Replace „głowa” with another body part as needed.

40. Czy jest tu apteka?

Is there a pharmacy nearby?

Useful for minor ailments.

41. Jestem uczulony / uczulona na...

I'm allergic to...

Important to know before eating out or taking medicine.

42. Potrzebuję lekarza

I need a doctor

Clear and direct in an emergency.

43. Proszę wezwać karetkę

Please call an ambulance

Reserve for genuine emergencies only.

7 Making Plans

44. Co robisz w weekend?

What are you doing this weekend?

Casual way to start planning something together.

45. Masz ochotę na kawę?

Fancy a coffee?

Common, friendly invitation.

46. O której się spotykamy?

What time are we meeting?

Confirms the details of an arrangement.

47. Gdzie się spotkamy?

Where shall we meet?

Pairs naturally with the phrase above.

48. Nie mogę dzisiaj

I can't today

Polite way to decline an invitation.

49. Może innym razem

Maybe another time

Soft, friendly way to postpone plans.

50. Do zobaczenia wkrótce!

See you soon!

Warm way to end plans for a future meeting.

Want to go further?

These 50 phrases are a start. If you'd like real conversations, structured lessons and a teacher with 20+ years of experience, here's where to go next:

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